

Adaptations for Survival

Use the cue, then fade the cue. Study the cue card for 60 seconds. Then cover it before answering Round 1. Check the card only after you commit to an answer.

CUE FOCUS An adaptation helps an organism survive in its environment. **Structural adaptations** are body parts, such as cactus spines, webbed feet, or thick fur. **Behavioral adaptations** are actions, such as birds migrating or bears hibernating.

Round 1 — Retrieve It

1. What is an adaptation? What does it help an organism do?

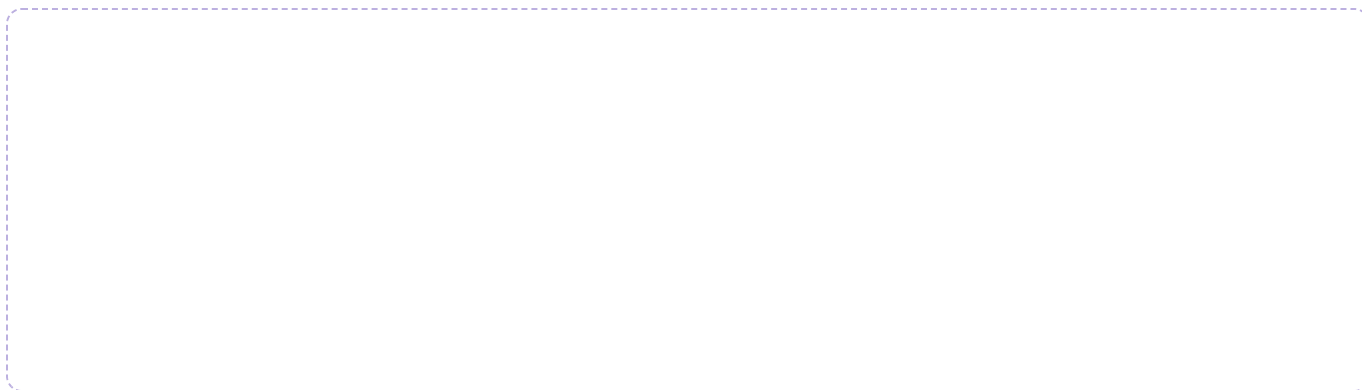
2. What is a structural adaptation? Give one example.

3. What is a behavioral adaptation? Give one example.

4. Is thick fur a structural adaptation or a behavioral adaptation?

Round 2 — Sketch It

Draw an animal with one structural adaptation. Label the body part and write how it helps the animal survive.



Adaptations for Survival — Apply It

Keep the cue card covered. Answer first. Then use the cue to check, revise, and explain what you changed.

Round 3 — Apply the Adaptation

1. A duck has webbed feet. Is this structural or behavioral, and how does it help the duck survive?

2. When winter comes, some birds fly south to a warmer place. Is this structural or behavioral, and how does it help them survive?

3. A cactus has sharp spines instead of soft leaves. Is this structural or behavioral, and how might it help the cactus survive?

Round 4 — Reason from Evidence

A polar bear has thick fur and hibernates in cold weather. Explain which of these is a structural adaptation and which is a behavioral adaptation, and how each one helps the bear survive.

Adaptations for Survival — ACE It

Use the cue card only if you need it. The goal is to show what you can explain, connect, and use on your own.

A**Articulate**

Explain the difference between a structural adaptation and a behavioral adaptation. Give one example of each.

C**Connect**

Pick one environment (desert, ocean, or forest). Connect one adaptation an animal there might have to a problem that environment causes.

E**Extend**

Invent an animal for a very cold, snowy place. Describe one structural adaptation and one behavioral adaptation that would help it survive there.

Confidence check. Circle one after you finish: I still need the cue / I need it once in a while / I can explain this without it.

Teacher Key — Adaptations for Survival

Remove this page before student copying. Answers below give expected ideas, not required wording.

Retrieve It

1. An adaptation is a feature or action that helps an organism survive in its environment.
2. A structural adaptation is a body part; example: cactus spines, webbed feet, or thick fur.
3. A behavioral adaptation is an action; example: birds migrating or bears hibernating.
4. Structural (it is a body part).

Sketch It — look for

An animal with a labeled body part (a structural adaptation) and a note explaining how that part helps the animal survive.

Apply It

1. Structural; webbed feet help the duck push water and swim well.
2. Behavioral; migrating (flying south) helps birds reach warmer places with food.
3. Structural; spines protect the cactus from animals and lose less water than soft leaves.

Reason from Evidence — look for

Thick fur is a structural adaptation (a body part) that keeps the bear warm. Hibernating is a behavioral adaptation (an action) that helps the bear survive winter when food is scarce.

ACE — Extend look-for

The invented animal has one clear structural adaptation (a body part, such as thick fur) and one clear behavioral adaptation (an action, such as hibernating), each matched to surviving the cold.

Suggested use. Run Page 1 with the cue card available, Page 2 with the cue mostly covered, and Page 3 as independent reflection. Let students uncover the cue to self-correct in a different color.